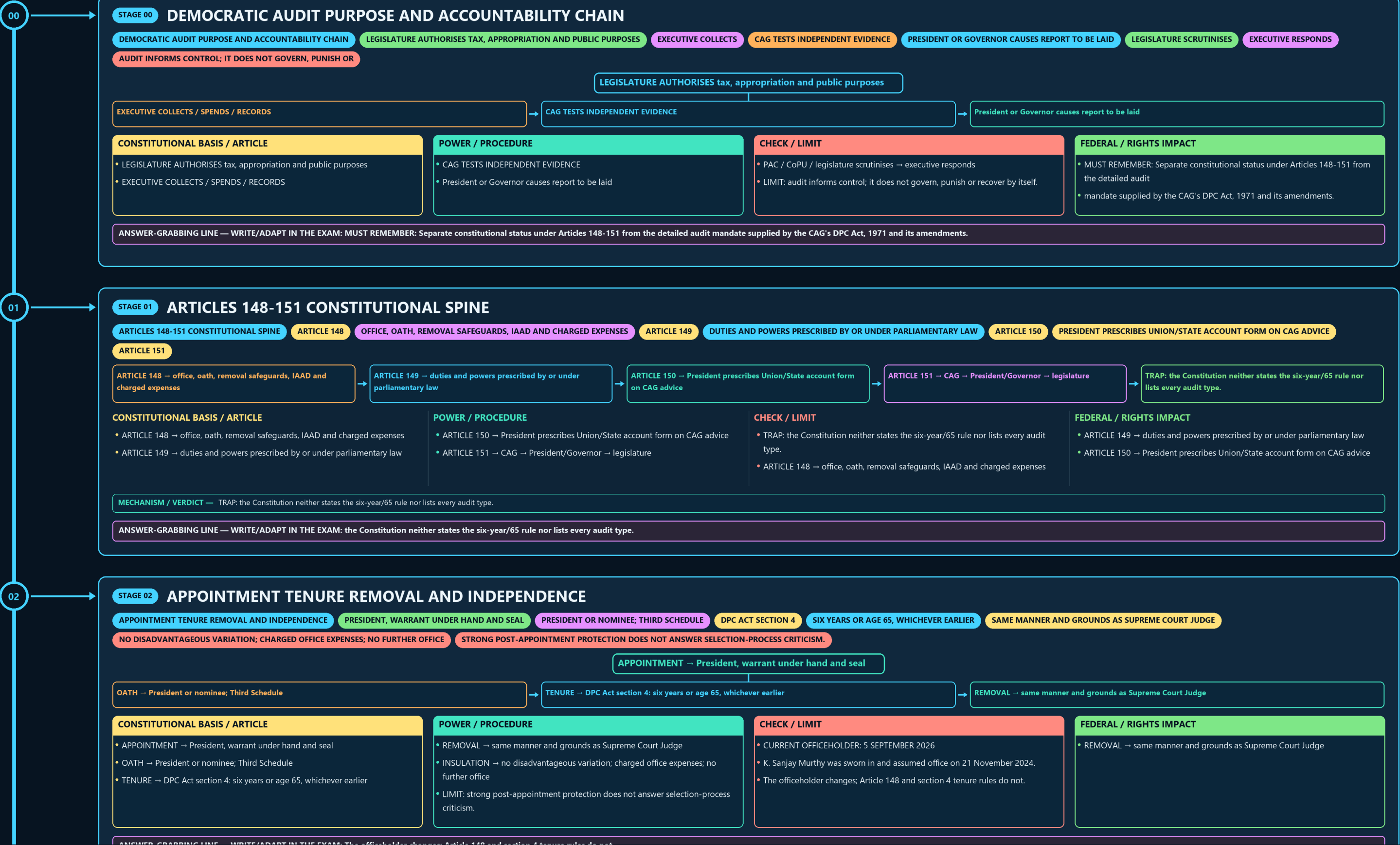


Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

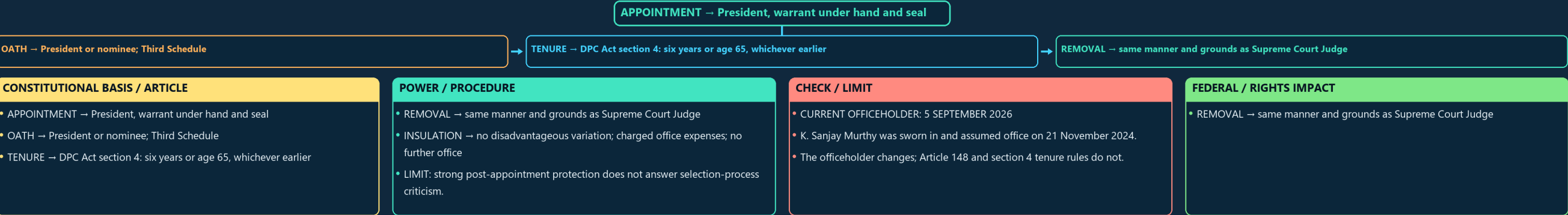


ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the Constitution neither states the six-year/65 rule nor lists every audit type.

02

STAGE 02 APPOINTMENT TENURE REMOVAL AND INDEPENDENCE

APPOINTMENT TENURE REMOVAL AND INDEPENDENCE PRESIDENT, WARRANT UNDER HAND AND SEAL PRESIDENT OR NOMINEE; THIRD SCHEDULE DPC ACT SECTION 4 SIX YEARS OR AGE 65, WHICHEVER EARLIER SAME MANNER AND GROUNDS AS SUPREME COURT JUDGE
NO DISADVANTAGEOUS VARIATION; CHARGED OFFICE EXPENSES; NO FURTHER OFFICE STRONG POST-APPOINTMENT PROTECTION DOES NOT ANSWER SELECTION-PROCESS CRITICISM.



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The officeholder changes; Article 148 and section 4 tenure rules do not.

03

STAGE 03 AUDIT ACCOUNTS AND THE 1976 BOUNDARY

AUDIT ACCOUNTS AND THE 1976 BOUNDARY ACCOUNTS CREATE AND COMPILE THE FINANCIAL RECORD AUDIT INDEPENDENTLY TESTS RECORDS AND TRANSACTIONS 1976 UNION DEPARTMENTALISATION MINISTRIES ASSUMED MUCH UNION COMPILATION DPC ACT SECTIONS 10-12
RESIDUAL ACCOUNTS ROLES WHERE RESPONSIBILITY REMAINS DPC ACT SECTIONS 13-20

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• ACCOUNTS create and compile the financial record • AUDIT independently tests records and transactions	• 1976 UNION DEPARTMENTALISATION → ministries assumed much Union compilation • DPC ACT SECTIONS 10-12 → residual accounts roles where responsibility remains	• DPC ACT SECTIONS 13-20 → audit mandate continues • INDIA: predominantly ex-post auditor, not routine pre-withdrawal comptroller.	• ACCOUNTS create and compile the financial record • AUDIT independently tests records and transactions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INDIA: predominantly ex-post auditor, not routine pre-withdrawal comptroller.

04

STAGE 04 PUBLIC FUNDS RECEIPTS GRANTS AND ACCESS

PUBLIC FUNDS RECEIPTS GRANTS AND ACCESS SECTION 13 CONSOLIDATED FUND EXPENDITURE AND FUND TRANSACTIONS SECTION 14 SUBSTANTIALLY FINANCED BODIES UNDER STATUTORY TESTS SECTION 15 SPECIFIC-PURPOSE GRANTS/LOANS AND SANCTIONING PROCEDURES SECTION 16

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• SECTION 13 → Consolidated Fund expenditure and fund transactions • SECTION 14 → substantially financed bodies under statutory tests	• SECTION 15 → specific-purpose grants/loans and sanctioning procedures • SECTION 16 → receipts payable into Consolidated Funds	• SECTION 17 → stores and stock • SECTION 18 → records and information	• TEST: entity → public-money nexus → legal gateway → proportionate record access. • SECTION 13 → Consolidated Fund expenditure and fund transactions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST: entity → public-money nexus → legal gateway → proportionate record access.

05

STAGE 05 FINANCIAL COMPLIANCE PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE AUDIT

FINANCIAL COMPLIANCE PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE AUDIT IS FINANCIAL INFORMATION FAIRLY PRESENTED? WERE LAW, SANCTION, RULE AND CONTRACT FOLLOWED? WAS DISCRETION FAITHFUL, PRUDENT AND ECONOMICAL? ECONOMY + EFFICIENCY + EFFECTIVENESS
SPECIALISED OBJECTS OR METHODS WITHIN LEGAL MANDATE TEST IMPLEMENTATION AND RESULTS; DO NOT REPLACE A LAWFUL CLOSE DISTINCTION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
FINANCIAL → is financial information fairly presented?	PROPRIETY → was discretion faithful, prudent and economical?	RECEIPTS / IT / ENVIRONMENT → specialised objects or methods within legal mandate	CLOSE DISTINCTION: The CAG is an ex-post auditor and reports through legislatures
COMPLIANCE → were law, sanction, rule and contract followed?	PERFORMANCE → economy + efficiency + effectiveness	BOUNDARY: test implementation and results; do not replace a lawful policy choice.	it does not pre-authorise expenditure, prosecute wrongdoing or enforce PAC action.
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
• FINANCIAL → is financial information fairly presented? • COMPLIANCE → were law, sanction, rule and contract followed?	• PROPRIETY → was discretion faithful, prudent and economical? • PERFORMANCE → economy + efficiency + effectiveness	• RECEIPTS / IT / ENVIRONMENT → specialised objects or methods within legal mandate • BOUNDARY: test implementation and results; do not replace a lawful policy choice.	• CLOSE DISTINCTION: The CAG is an ex-post auditor and reports through legislatures • It does not pre-authorise expenditure, prosecute wrongdoing or enforce PAC action.

05

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- SECTION 13 → Consolidated Fund expenditure and fund transactions
- SECTION 14 → substantially financed bodies under statutory tests

POWER / PROCEDURE

- SECTION 15 → specific-purpose grants/loans and sanctioning procedures
- SECTION 16 → receipts payable into Consolidated Funds

CHECK / LIMIT

- SECTION 17 → stores and stock
- SECTION 18 → records and information

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- TEST: entity → public-money nexus → legal gateway → proportionate record access.
- SECTION 13 → Consolidated Fund expenditure and fund transactions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST: entity → public-money nexus → legal gateway → proportionate record access.

06

STAGE 05

FINANCIAL COMPLIANCE PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE AUDIT

FINANCIAL COMPLIANCE PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE AUDIT

IS FINANCIAL INFORMATION FAIRLY PRESENTED?

WERE LAW, SANCTION, RULE AND CONTRACT FOLLOWED?

WAS DISCRETION FAITHFUL, PRUDENT AND ECONOMICAL?

ECONOMY + EFFICIENCY + EFFECTIVENESS

SPECIALISED OBJECTS OR METHODS WITHIN LEGAL MANDATE

TEST IMPLEMENTATION AND RESULTS; DO NOT REPLACE A LAWFUL

CLOSE DISTINCTION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

FINANCIAL → is financial information fairly presented?

COMPLIANCE → were law, sanction, rule and contract followed?

POWER / PROCEDURE

PROPRIETY → was discretion faithful, prudent and economical?

PERFORMANCE → economy + efficiency + effectiveness

CHECK / LIMIT

RECEIPTS / IT / ENVIRONMENT → specialised objects or methods within legal mandate

BOUNDARY: test implementation and results; do not replace a lawful policy choice.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The CAG is an ex-post auditor and reports through legislatures

it does not pre-authorise expenditure, prosecute wrongdoing or enforce PAC action.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- FINANCIAL → is financial information fairly presented?
- COMPLIANCE → were law, sanction, rule and contract followed?

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PROPRIETY → was discretion faithful, prudent and economical?
- PERFORMANCE → economy + efficiency + effectiveness

CHECK / LIMIT

- RECEIPTS / IT / ENVIRONMENT → specialised objects or methods within legal mandate
- BOUNDARY: test implementation and results; do not replace a lawful policy choice.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: The CAG is an ex-post auditor and reports through legislatures
- it does not pre-authorise expenditure, prosecute wrongdoing or enforce PAC action.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — COMPLIANCE → were law, sanction, rule and contract followed?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPLIANCE → were law, sanction, rule and contract followed?.

07

STAGE 06

GOVERNMENT COMPANIES AND STATUTORY CORPORATIONS

GOVERNMENT COMPANIES AND STATUTORY CORPORATIONS

GOVERNMENT COMPANY

COMPANIES ACT SECTION 139

CAG APPOINTS STATUTORY AUDITOR SECTION 143

DIRECTIONS, SUPPLEMENTARY AUDIT/COMMENTS AND TEST AUDIT

STATUTORY CORPORATION ESTABLISHING LAW + DPC ACT SECTION 19

OWNERSHIP LABEL ALONE DOES NOT ESTABLISH IDENTICAL CAG COVERAGE.

GOVERNMENT COMPANY

Companies Act section 139 → CAG appoints statutory auditor section 143 → directions, supplementary audit/comments

STATUTORY CORPORATION establishing law + DPC Act section 19 determine the route

TRAP: ownership label alone does not establish identical CAG coverage.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- GOVERNMENT COMPANY
- Companies Act section 139 → CAG appoints statutory auditor section 143 → directions, supplementary audit/comments and test audit

POWER / PROCEDURE

- STATUTORY CORPORATION establishing law + DPC Act section 19 determine the route
- TRAP: ownership label alone does not establish identical CAG coverage.

CHECK / LIMIT

- GOVERNMENT COMPANY
- Companies Act section 139 → CAG appoints statutory auditor section 143 → directions, supplementary audit/comments and test audit

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- STATUTORY CORPORATION establishing law + DPC Act section 19 determine the route
- TRAP: ownership label alone does not establish identical CAG coverage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ownership label alone does not establish identical CAG coverage.

08

STAGE 07

PRIVATE ENTITIES PPPS AND REVENUE NEXUS

PRIVATE ENTITIES PPPS AND REVENUE NEXUS

PRIVATE STATUS DOES NOT BAR OR CREATE AUDIT

SECTIONS 14

20 OR A SPECIAL LAW MUST SUPPLY THE GATEWAY

PPP AUDIT FOLLOWS GRANTS, GUARANTEES, ASSETS, USER FEES OR

TELECOM CASE (2014)

RECORDS NEEDED TO VERIFY UNION REVENUE SHARE COULD BE

AUDIT OF THE PUBLIC NEXUS IS NOT UNIVERSAL AUDIT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRIVATE STATUS DOES NOT BAR OR CREATE AUDIT
- Sections 14 / 15 / 16 / 20 or a special law must supply the gateway

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PPP audit follows grants, guarantees, assets, user fees or revenue share only as authorised
- TELECOM CASE (2014) → records needed to verify Union revenue share could be accessed

CHECK / LIMIT

- LIMIT: audit of the public nexus is not universal audit of unrelated private business.
- PRIVATE STATUS DOES NOT BAR OR CREATE AUDIT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Sections 14 / 15 / 16 / 20 or a special law must supply the gateway
- PPP audit follows grants, guarantees, assets, user fees or revenue share only as authorised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: audit of the public nexus is not universal audit of unrelated private business.

08

STAGE 08

LOCAL BODIES AND FEDERAL AUDIT VARIATION

CAG • TILE 3/5 • same master rows 4359-7593 of 11952 • continues below

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ownership label alone does not establish identical CAG coverage.

07

STAGE 07 PRIVATE ENTITIES PPPS AND REVENUE NEXUS

PRIVATE ENTITIES PPPS AND REVENUE NEXUS

PRIVATE STATUS DOES NOT BAR OR CREATE AUDIT

SECTIONS 14

20 OR A SPECIAL LAW MUST SUPPLY THE GATEWAY

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- PRIVATE STATUS DOES NOT BAR OR CREATE AUDIT
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- TELECOM CASE (2014) → records needed to verify Union revenue share could be accessed

CHECK / LIMIT

- LIMIT: audit of the public nexus is not universal audit of unrelated private business.
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FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Sections 14 / 15 / 16 / 20 or a special law must supply the gateway
- PPP audit follows grants, guarantees, assets, user fees or revenue share only as authorised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: audit of the public nexus is not universal audit of unrelated private business.

08

STAGE 08 LOCAL BODIES AND FEDERAL AUDIT VARIATION

LOCAL BODIES AND FEDERAL AUDIT VARIATION

ARTICLES 243J

STATE LEGISLATURES PROVIDE LOCAL-ACCOUNT AUDIT ARRANGEMENTS

STATE LAW

PRIMARY AUDITOR AND PROCEDURE MAY VARY

DIRECT STATUTORY/ENTRUSTED AUDIT WHERE APPLICABLE

TECHNICAL GUIDANCE AND SUPPORT

CAPACITY AND STANDARDISATION ROUTE

ARTICLES 243J / 243Z → State legislatures provide local-account audit arrangements

STATE LAW → primary auditor and procedure may vary

CAG → direct statutory/entrusted audit where applicable

TECHNICAL GUIDANCE AND SUPPORT → capacity and standardisation route

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLES 243J / 243Z → State legislatures provide local-account audit arrangements
- STATE LAW → primary auditor and procedure may vary

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CAG → direct statutory/entrusted audit where applicable
- TECHNICAL GUIDANCE AND SUPPORT → capacity and standardisation route

CHECK / LIMIT

- FINANCE COMMISSION LINK → local grants require traceable accounts and audit
- TRAP: India has no single uniform constitutional CAG audit model for every local body.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLES 243J / 243Z → State legislatures provide local-account audit arrangements
- STATE LAW → primary auditor and procedure may vary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: India has no single uniform constitutional CAG audit model for every local body.

09

STAGE 09 REPORTS PAC COPU AND LEGISLATIVE FOLLOW-UP

REPORTS PAC COPU AND LEGISLATIVE FOLLOW-UP

BOTH HOUSES

STATE LEGISLATURE

FINANCE ACCOUNTS AND RELEVANT CAG REPORTS

PUBLIC UNDERTAKINGS AND RELATED CAG REPORTS

ACTION-TAKEN RESPONSE

CAG ASSISTS TECHNICALLY; REPORT

COMMITTEE CONCLUSION

UNION: CAG → President → both Houses

STATE: CAG → Governor → State legislature

PAC → appropriation / finance accounts and relevant CAG reports

CoPU → public undertakings and related CAG reports

COMMITTEE → evidence → finding → action-taken response → follow-up

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- UNION: CAG → President → both Houses
- STATE: CAG → Governor → State legislature

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PAC → appropriation / finance accounts and relevant CAG reports
- CoPU → public undertakings and related CAG reports

CHECK / LIMIT

- COMMITTEE → evidence → finding → action-taken response → follow-up
- CAG assists technically; report != committee conclusion != automatic liability.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- UNION: CAG → President → both Houses
- STATE: CAG → Governor → State legislature

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAG assists technically; report != committee conclusion != automatic liability.

10

STAGE 10 JUDICIAL CONTROLS AND LEGAL LIMITS

JUDICIAL CONTROLS AND LEGAL LIMITS

ARVIND GUPTA (2012)

PERFORMANCE AUDIT AND THE THREE ES SUPPORTED

S. SUBRAMANIAM BALAJI (2013)

POST-EXPENDITURE LEGALITY, VALIDITY AND PROPRIETY

ARUN KUMAR AGRAWAL (2013)

CAG REPORT RESPECTED BUT LEGISLATIVE SCRUTINY REMAINS

ASSOCIATION OF UNIFIED TELECOM SERVICE PROVIDERS OF INDIA V.

ARVIND GUPTA (2012) → performance audit and the three Es supported

S. SUBRAMANIAM BALAJI (2013) → post-expenditure legality, validity and propriety

ARUN KUMAR AGRAWAL (2013) → CAG report respected but legislative scrutiny remains

Association of Unified Telecom Service Providers of India v. Union of India (2014) → revenue-share

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARVIND GUPTA (2012) → performance audit and the three Es supported

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARUN KUMAR AGRAWAL (2013) → CAG report respected but legislative

CHECK / LIMIT

- SYNTHESIS: broad evidence role + ex-post timing + no adjudicatory finality.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- S. SUBRAMANIAM BALAJI (2013) → post-expenditure legality, validity and

reports

follow-up

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• UNION: CAG → President → both Houses

• STATE: CAG → Governor → State legislature

POWER / PROCEDURE

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CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• ARVIND GUPTA (2012) → performance audit and the three Es supported

• S. SUBRAMANIAM BALAJI (2013) → post-expenditure legality, validity and propriety

POWER / PROCEDURE

• ARUN KUMAR AGRAWAL (2013) → CAG report respected but legislative scrutiny remains

• Association of Unified Telecom Service Providers of India v. Union of India (2014) → revenue-share access, not universal private audit

CHECK / LIMIT

• SYNTHESIS: broad evidence role + ex-post timing + no adjudicatory finality.

• ARVIND GUPTA (2012) → performance audit and the three Es supported

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• S. SUBRAMANIAM BALAJI (2013) → post-expenditure legality, validity and propriety

• ARUN KUMAR AGRAWAL (2013) → CAG report respected but legislative scrutiny remains

MECHANISM / VERDICT — SYNTHESIS: broad evidence role + ex-post timing + no adjudicatory finality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: broad evidence role + ex-post timing + no adjudicatory finality.

11

STAGE 11 COMPARISON REFORM PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

COMPARISON REFORM PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

CONSTITUTIONAL AUDIT

UNION EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTING

FINANCE COMMISSION

ARTICLE 280 TRANSFERS

ARTICLE 279 NET PROCEEDS CERTIFICATE

TRANSPARENT SELECTION + SECURE DATA + PPP CLAUSES +

PYQ 2018

CAG → constitutional audit

CGA → Union executive accounting

FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 transfers

CAG → Article 279 net proceeds certificate

REFORM → transparent selection + secure data + PPP clauses + timely tabling/follow-up

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• CAG → constitutional audit

• CGA → Union executive accounting

• FINANCE COMMISSION → Article 280 transfers

POWER / PROCEDURE

• CAG → Article 279 net proceeds certificate

• REFORM → transparent selection + secure data + PPP clauses + timely tabling/follow-up

• PYQ 2018 → appointment, terms and powers

CHECK / LIMIT

• PYQ 2024 → legality plus propriety

• MAINS SPINE: independence → mandate → audit type/entity route → report chain

• limit → targeted reform → evidence-led accountability verdict.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The official CAG page identifies K. Sanjay Murthy as CAG from 21 November

• 2024; the statutory term remains six years or age sixty-five.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: limit → targeted reform → evidence-led accountability verdict.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

COMPARATIVE AND INSTITUTIONAL ENRICHMENT

[ANALYSIS] THE BRITISH COMPARISON IS USEFUL ONLY FOR THE

INDIA DOES NOT ORDINARILY REQUIRE CAG AUTHORISATION

IT DOES NOT PROVE THAT INDIAN AUDIT IS INSTITUTIONALLY

[ANALYSIS] PAUL APPLEBY'S CRITICISM OF TRADITIONAL AUDIT AS NEGATIVE

EFFICIENCY-VERSUS-CONTROL DEBATE, BUT IT IS NOT A LEGAL LIMIT

[CURRENT] REMOTE AUDIT, SECURE DATA INTERFACES AND ANALYTICS CAN

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

• Comparative and institutional enrichment

• [ANALYSIS] The British comparison is useful only for the ex-ante/ex-post distinction: India does not ordinarily require CAG authorisation

• It does not prove that Indian audit is institutionally weak.

• [ANALYSIS] Paul Appleby's criticism of traditional audit as negative may introduce the

ADVANCED LIMIT

• efficiency-versus-control debate, but it is not a legal limit on the CAG.

• [CURRENT] Remote audit, secure data interfaces and analytics can improve risk selection and timeliness

• every flagged anomaly still requires lawful jurisdiction, auditable evidence and human verification.

• [LIMIT] Appointment reform, PPP clauses and stronger local-body audit are proposals or design choices.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

• Do not present them as existing constitutional commands.

• Comparative and institutional enrichment - [ANALYSIS] The British comparison is useful only for

• the ex-ante/ex-post distinction: India does not ordinarily require CAG authorisation before each withdrawal.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.